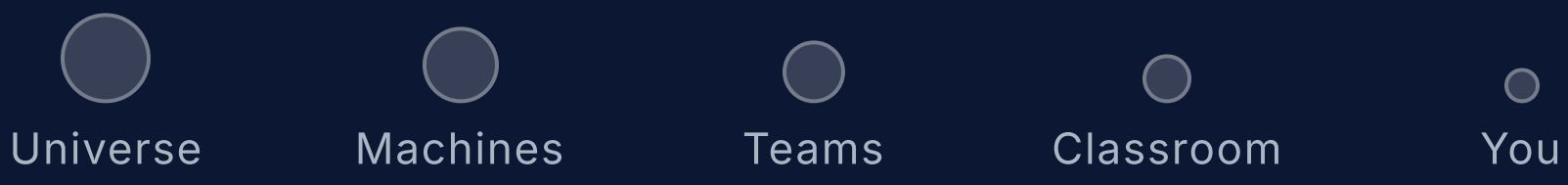
SIX ESSAYS · FROM PHYSICS TO THE CLASSROOM

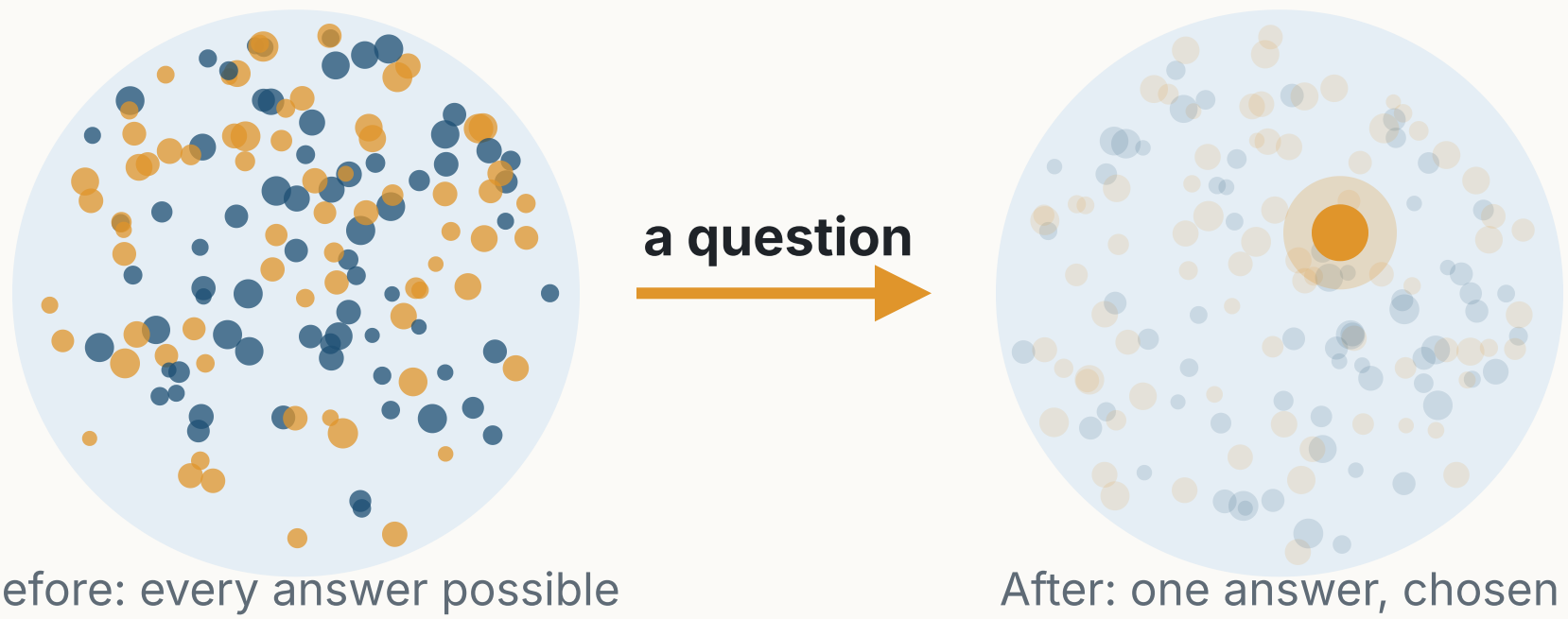
Answers are cheap. Questions are ours.

What stays human when AI can answer almost anything, seen at five scales.



PHYSICS

An answer needs someone asking.



Before: every answer possible

After: one answer, chosen

Seen from outside, a closed universe has exactly one possible state: nothing to know. Put an observer inside and the possibilities come back. A language model is similar: it holds every answer, weighted, none chosen, until a question arrives from somewhere.

Essay · **Nothing From Outside, Everything From Inside**

AI EXPERIMENTS

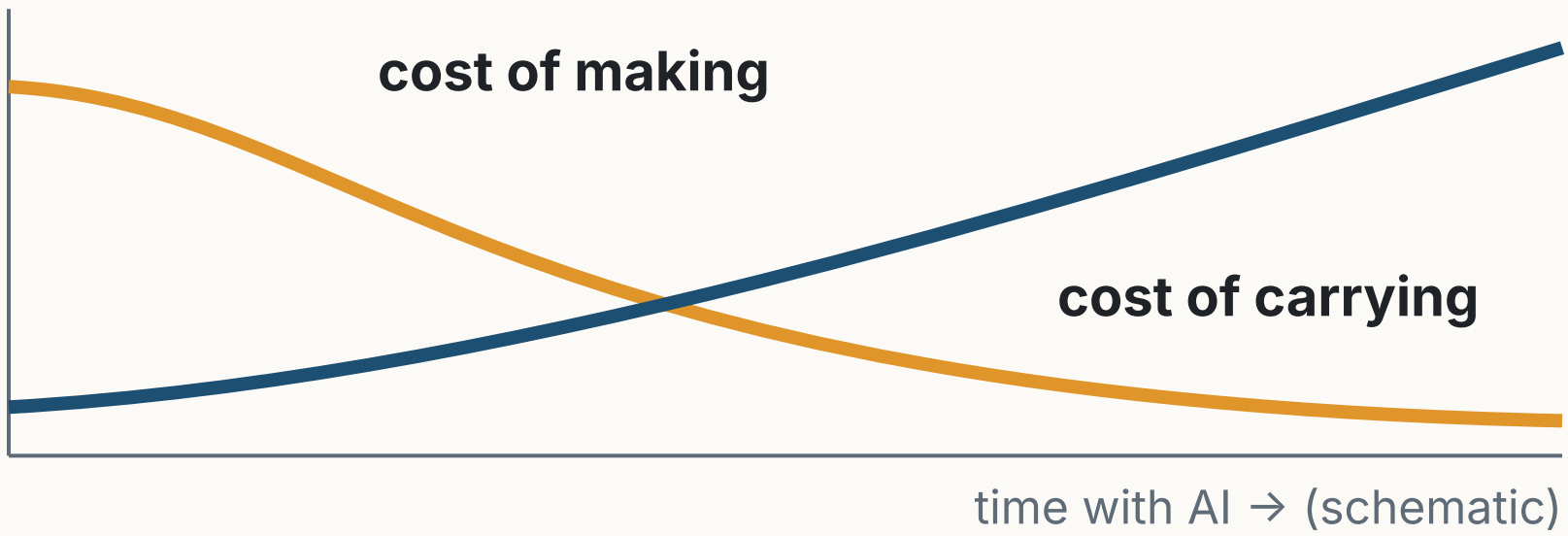
Truth is what survives comparison.



When ten of my networks all agreed, they were right **99.8%** of the time. But when they had all learned the same shortcut, their agreement was worth no more than chance. Coherent is not true. Check against the world.

TEAMS

Everything you make, you carry.



AI lowers the cost of making, not of carrying. So make less, and carry it well: approve only what you cannot undo, watch everything else, and let processes get lighter as the work gets heavier.

CLASSROOM

The skill is in the effort.

−17%

Practised with a plain chatbot

≈ 0

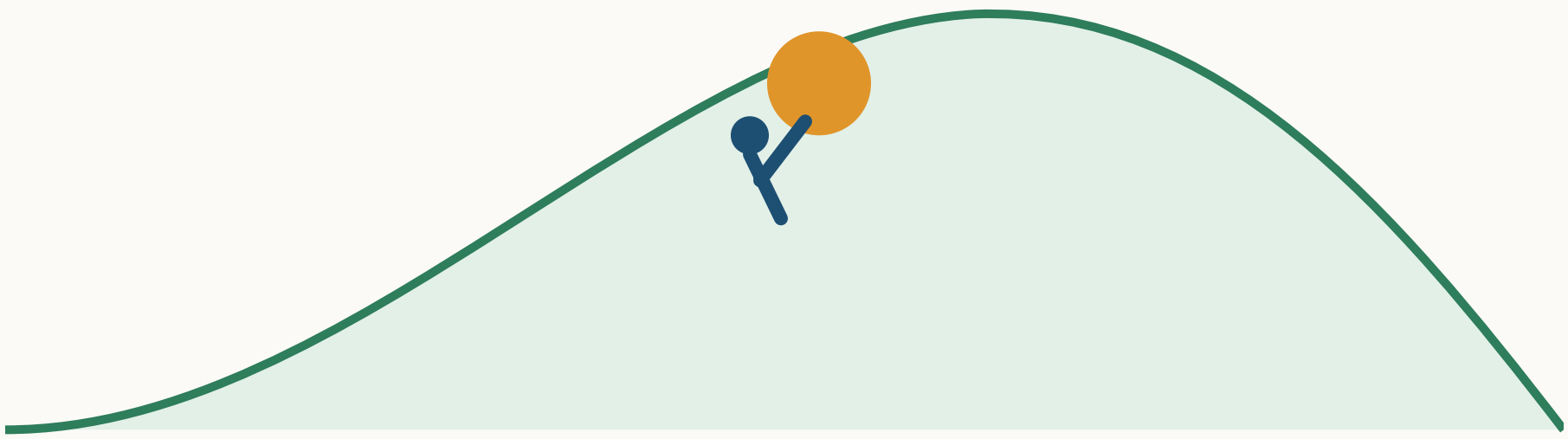
Practised with a tutor that gives hints, not answers

Exam scores once the AI was taken away, compared with students who never had it (~1,000 students; Bastani et al., *PNAS*, 2025)

A tool that does the climbing for you takes the learning with it. A tool that keeps the effort does no harm.

PHILOSOPHY

A machine has no reason to want an answer. We do.



“One must imagine Sisyphus happy,” wrote Camus. Being first at the top is not the same as being glad to be there. Choosing the question, and caring about it, is not a task to automate.

Answers are cheap.
Questions are ours.

Ask from somewhere.
An answer means something only to someone.

Compare, then check against the world.
Agreement is not truth.

Carry only what matters.
Making is free; keeping is not.

Keep the effort, and the joy.
That is where the skill comes from.

What question would you never hand to a machine?

Essays, experiments and code, in English and French

scuenat.github.io

Tell me in the comments. Good questions often become the next essay.